

YUZHOU (EMRYS)

PhD Candidate in Economics | Applied Research & Policy Analysis
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PROFILE

PhD candidate in Economics at the Australian National University (ANU) with a peer-reviewed Q1 publication in applied microeconomics. A fast learner who rapidly masters new tools and methodologies, and a dependable team player with a strong track record of contributing effectively across research, teaching, committee, and professional environments. Adept at translating complex quantitative findings into clear, evidence-based recommendations for diverse audiences.

PUBLICATION

Dai, C., & Zhou, Y. (2025). Rank, peer achievement, and shadow education: Evidence from secondary school students in China. *Economics of Education Review*, Vol. 108, Oct. 2025, 102682. doi.org/10.1016/j.econedurev.2025.102682

WORKING PAPERS

Zhou, Y. (2025). *When Ambitions Align: Peer Parental Aspiration and Student Achievement*. Available at SSRN: papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=5575350

CAREER GOALS

- **Short-term:** Secure a policy analyst position within a State Government agency, applying econometric and data analysis skills to deliver evidence-based policy analysis and actionable recommendations to government decision-makers.
- **Long-term:** Develop into a senior policy adviser with influence over the design of targeted, evidence-based policies that address education inequality and improve outcomes for disadvantaged communities.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Proficient in Python** (pandas, numpy, scipy, statsmodels, matplotlib, seaborn) for data cleaning, statistical modelling, and visualisation
- **Proficient in R** (tidyverse, fixest, sandwich/lmtest, R Markdown) for regression analysis, robust inference, and reproducible reporting
- **Proficient in Microsoft Excel and PowerPoint:** advanced pivot tables, formula-driven modelling, and data-driven presentations
- **Sound research interpretation and presentation skills;** experienced in communicating technical findings clearly to both specialist and general audiences
- **Causal inference methods:** Instrumental Variables (IV), Regression Discontinuity Design (RDD), Difference-in-Differences (DiD), and panel data methods with fixed and random effects

EDUCATION

2022–Present Doctor of Philosophy in Economics — Australian National University, Canberra

Applied microeconomics; labour economics; causal inference. Expected submission: late 2026.

– Postgraduate Research Scholarship, ANU (2023–2027)

– Higher Degree by Research (HDR) Fee Remission Merit Scholarship, ANU (2023–2027)

2020–2022 Master of Economics — Australian National University, Canberra

Econometric methods, statistical modelling, economic policy analysis.

2016–2020 Bachelor of Auditing — Shanghai Lixin University of Accounting and Finance

– National English Competition for College Students — First Prize (2019)

– National English Competition for College Students — Third Prize (2018)

– 4th National College Student Financial Elite Challenge — Third Prize (2018)

– Multiple Academic Scholarships (2017–2020)

2021 Graduate Certificate of Finance — Antwerp School of Management

2020 Securities Analyst Qualification — China Securities Association

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Seminar Coordinator | Research School of Economics, ANU | Jul 2025 – Present

Responsibilities:

- Manage the RSE seminar programme end-to-end — speaker invitations, scheduling, venue logistics, and communications with academic staff, visiting researchers, and professional services.
- Coordinate across the school and with external institutions to ensure seamless delivery of all academic events.

Achievements:

- Built cross-institutional networks spanning Australian and international economics communities; consistently delivered high-quality events through proactive planning and team coordination.

Committee Member | Economic Society of Australia (ACT Branch) | 2025 – Present

- Plan and coordinate professional seminars and events connecting economists, policymakers, and researchers across government, academia, and industry.
- Strengthened stakeholder engagement and cross-sector communication skills through voluntary leadership within a professional economics association.

Academic Mentor | Toad Hall, Australian National University | 2024 – Present

- Deliver one-on-one mentoring and tailored written feedback to undergraduate residents; collaborate with the mentor team to identify and support at-risk students.
- Developed active listening, empathy, and interpersonal communication through sustained mentoring relationships with students from diverse backgrounds.

Archive Records Clerk | Australian Family Lawyers, Canberra | 2023 – 2024

- Processed and archived sensitive legal documents to strict confidentiality standards; adapted rapidly to new systems and contributed reliably to team operations from day one.

PhD Researcher and Economics Tutor | Australian National University, Canberra | 2022 – Present

Responsibilities:

- Construct and manage multi-cohort administrative datasets; perform end-to-end data cleaning, merging, deduplication, and validation across multiple sources.
- Apply IV and RDD causal inference methods to large-scale microdata; produce peer-reviewed outputs and policy-facing manuscripts to publication standard.
- Tutor undergraduate Economics students each semester; design and mark assessments and provide structured written and verbal feedback.

Achievements:

- Published in *Economics of Education Review* (Q1, Vol. 108, 2025) — causal evidence on education inequality and shadow education in China, framed for policy audiences.
- Independently managed a multi-year research pipeline from data acquisition to publication; rapidly mastered advanced technical skills under minimal supervision.
- Sustained research output alongside concurrent teaching, mentoring, and committee commitments, demonstrating consistent reliability and effective time management.

Fixed Income Division Intern | Guosen Securities Co., Ltd., China | Jun – Aug 2021

- Reviewed bond prospectuses and verified 17 documentation packages for regulatory compliance; completed all assignments with zero material errors.

- Integrated quickly into the team and met all project deadlines in a fast-paced financial services environment.

Analyst Intern — Smart Education Department | PingAn Technology Shenzhen Co., Ltd., China | Dec 2019 – Feb 2021

- Maintained and quality-checked administrative datasets for education product analytics; produced structured data outputs for strategic and revenue pipeline reporting.
- Rapidly developed data management proficiency; contributed reliably to team reporting goals through accurate, timely processing.

Commercial Insurance Intern | AXA Tianping Co., Ltd., China | Aug – Nov 2019

- Managed policy issuance and commercial budget accountabilities; tracked campaign results across 20+ client accounts and collaborated closely with the commercial team.

KEY SKILLS

- **Problem solving:** Diagnoses complex data and research challenges and develops clear, systematic solutions independently, including under tight timelines.
- **Commitment to continuous learning:** Proactively expands capabilities; independently mastered Python, R, and advanced causal inference methods alongside full-time doctoral research.
- **Resilience under pressure:** Maintains high performance and professional conduct across demanding, concurrent commitments with competing deadlines.
- **Time management:** Plans and manages workload proactively to meet deadlines across research, teaching, event coordination, and mentoring responsibilities simultaneously.
- **Prioritising tasks:** Assesses competing priorities and directs effort where it has the greatest impact; adapts quickly when requirements or stakeholder needs change.

LANGUAGES

- **English:** Professional fluency — advanced written and spoken communication.
- **Mandarin Chinese:** Professional fluency (native speaker).

REFEREES

Prof. Ashley C. Craig

Senior Lecturer and John Mitchell Research Fellow
Research School of Economics, Australian National University
Email: ashley.craig@anu.edu.au

Prof. Maria Racionero

Associate Professor | Member of Women in Economics Network
Research School of Economics, Australian National University
Email: maria.racionero@anu.edu.au